

Instructors: End of Session

Instructors must sign a **Letter of Reference** for each student.

- Letter of Reference
 - Instructors are asked to write a brief, generic paragraph describing their course, and outlining what students have learned. This is sent to PDs, along with a copy of their electronic signature. HQ staff compiles the Letters of Reference and forwards in pdf to the family. Some instructors prefer to write individual paragraphs for their students. In this case, the letters are compiled by HQ staff.
 - Sample [letter](#) here and in portal.
 - May be withheld as punishment for bad behavior or extended absences.



July 28, 2023

To Whom It May Concern,

I had the pleasure of teaching Lynn Atassi in the Trial Law Program at Summer Springboard on the Georgetown University campus from July 21 – July 27, 2023. She actively participated in all aspects of the academic program and has my highest recommendation.

Summer Springboard is a company founded to give college-bound teens a supportive environment where they can explore their personal and academic passions. Through our pre-college summer programs at Georgetown University combine the benefits of an challenging summer experience with tools and frameworks for personal leadership and self-discovery.

During the nine-day program, students received exposure to Trial Advocacy beginning with the history of American Jurisprudence, the elements of a trial: theme and theory, opening statement, direct examination, cross examination, closing argument, and rebuttal. They also watched videos of actual trials and participated in advocacy drill. The experiential program combined lectures with on-your-feet examinations to fully develop advocacy skills. To bolster the in-class instruction the students participated in a mock trial in a law school courtroom where they performed trial skills and a local courthouse where they acted as a sitting judge and watched actual litigation matters. For the culmination of their program the students were given a mock case involving a first-degree murder where they had to prepare their trial preparation from theme to closing argument working as either the prosecution or defense. All students were given the role of an attorney and performed a segment of the trial as a witness role.

Throughout the program she was an enthusiastic and respectful participant who represented her team well and volunteered for exercises and drills. Her performance in the final mock trial was impressive and showed future promise as a member of the legal profession. I can say enough about Lynn. She was a joy to have in the program and I look forward to seeing wonderful things about her future success.

Best Regards,

Cynthia Goode Works, J.D., LL.M.
Director, Stephen S. Weinstein Advocacy Program
Advisor, LL.M. in Advocacy
Adjunct Law Professor
American University Washington College of Law
goodecworks@wcl.american.edu

